

## Topic 7: Superpowers

### Overview

Superpowers can be developed by a number of characteristics. The pattern of dominance has changed over time. Superpowers and emerging superpowers have a very significant impact on the global economy, global politics and the environment. The spheres of influence between these powers are frequently contested, resulting in geopolitical implications.

### Content

| Enquiry question 1: What are superpowers and how have they changed over time?                          |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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| Key idea                                                                                               | Detailed content                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>7.1</b> Geopolitical power stems from a range of human and physical characteristics of superpowers. | a. Superpowers, emerging and regional powers can be defined using contrasting characteristics (economic, political, military, cultural, demographic and access to natural resources). (1) |
|                                                                                                        | b. Mechanisms for maintaining power sit on a spectrum from 'hard' to 'soft' power, which vary in their effectiveness.                                                                     |
|                                                                                                        | c. The relative importance of these characteristics and mechanisms for maintaining power has changed over time (🌐 China's 'belt and road' policy).                                        |